

EVIDENCE • CANVAS • SERIES

# word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

# Weight is meaning in a word cloud.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A  
A  
a

less

constellation scatters the words like stars.

---

substance **function**

**component**

gallery

**form** **manifest**

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A  
A  
a

less

dense packs the cloud tight.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A

A

a

less

spectrum colors the words along a scale.

---

function substance  
universal  
component gallery  
variant form manifest

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A  
A  
a

less

focal crowns one word the center.

---

gallery declared  
**variants**  
docs manifest

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A  
A  
a

less

# Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts (512 → 5).



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# When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

## Precise comparisons

If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

## Two or three words

A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

## Multi-word phrases

Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalise to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers, not  
a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form  
themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the  
frequency

`list` — single-line takeaways — the `takeaway` variant